

# OVERLOAD

Written By

Section 3

An Eight-Minute DDoS Awareness Screenplay

## Cast of Characters

SARAH - A practical and determined student who waits for the EcoCart sale with her classmates. She becomes one of the many legitimate customers affected when the website suddenly stops working.

SELLER / ECOCART OWNER - The person responsible for the business and its online store. Concerned about the failed sale, the seller later calls an incident meeting to understand what happened and how the company will prevent another attack.

STORE MANAGER - The manager responsible for sales operations, employees, and customer service. Confident before the sale, but immediately concerned when the website becomes unavailable.

SERVER ADMIN 1 - A member of EcoCart's technical team who monitors server performance, identifies the abnormal traffic spike, and helps restore the service.

SERVER ADMIN 2 - A second technical specialist who filters malicious traffic, coordinates with the security provider, and explains the company's recovery actions.

CYBERSECURITY ANALYST - The specialist who confirms that the event is a Distributed Denial-of-Service attack and explains the botnet, the threat, and the recommended preventive controls.

INCIDENT RESPONSE LEAD - The person who coordinates the company's response, records the actions taken, and recommends a clear incident response plan for future emergencies.

ATTACKER - A hidden figure who controls a group of compromised devices and orders them to flood the EcoCart server with repeated requests.

CLASSMATES / STUDENTS - Ten to twelve students who discuss the Big Blowout Sale, prepare their carts, and later react when their purchases cannot be completed.

CONSTRUCTION WORKERS - Five to six workers resting during their break. They hope to buy discounted safety equipment, tools, and work supplies.

PICK ME RIDER - A ride-hailing rider who plans to buy motorcycle accessories and rain gear before returning to work.

NANAYS AND BARANGAY RESIDENTS - Six to eight neighbors who begin by discussing a local barangay issue, but quickly change the topic when the online sale starts.

MOTHER AND FAMILY MEMBERS - A mother caring for an infant, supported by two relatives or friends. She hopes the sale will help her save money on essential baby products.

STORE EMPLOYEES AND CUSTOMERS - Five to seven ensemble members who prepare orders, assist shoppers, and show the scale of EcoCart's expected sale activity.

BOTNET REPRESENTATIVES - Students who visually represent infected phones, computers, and other devices repeatedly sending fake requests. These roles may be played by actors from earlier scenes.

#### ENSEMBLE / MULTI-ROLE ACTORS:

- Classmates: Ten to twelve students who discuss the Big Blowout Sale, prepare their carts, and later react when their purchases cannot be completed.
- Construction Workers (wearing safety vests): Five to six workers resting during their break. They hope to buy discounted safety equipment, tools, and work supplies.
- Store Employees and Customers : Five to seven ensemble members who prepare orders, assist shoppers, and show the scale of EcoCart's expected sale activity.
- Botnet Representatives (holding red screens): Students who visually represent infected phones, computers, and other devices repeatedly sending fake requests. These roles may be played by actors from earlier scenes.
- Barangay Neighbors: Six to eight neighbors who begin by discussing a local barangay issue, but quickly change the topic when the online sale starts.

- **Delivery Rider:** A ride-hailing rider who plans to buy motorcycle accessories and rain gear before returning to work.
- **Mother with Infant and Family (using props):** A mother caring for an infant, supported by two relatives or friends. She hopes the sale will help her save money on essential baby products.

### Setting:

A busy weekday at noon during EcoCart's largest online promotion. The story moves between a classroom, an EcoCart store, a construction site, a barangay waiting shed, a small family home, Sarah's bedroom, an unknown attacker's room, EcoCart's IT office, and the company conference room. The locations may be recorded separately and connected through quick cuts, split-screen shots, phone close-ups, and short montage sequences.

### At Rise:

People from different parts of the community are waiting for the EcoCart Big Blowout Sale. Students have prepared their shopping carts. Workers are looking for affordable equipment. Parents are hoping to save money on household needs. Inside EcoCart, employees expect a record number of orders. None of them knows that an attacker is preparing to flood the website with malicious traffic.

### Production Note:

The screenplay is designed for approximately thirty to forty students and a total video duration of about eight minutes. Ensemble actors may appear in more than one short scene. Dialogue should be delivered naturally, while transitions and reaction shots should remain quick to protect the running time.

### Budget Filming Strategy:

- **EcoCart HQ / Store:** Filmed in an empty campus classroom or org room. Stack 8-10 plain cardboard boxes taped with printed "EcoCart" paper logos to simulate a fulfillment hub.
- **Construction Site:** Shot outdoors against a brick/concrete campus wall. Actors wear bright safety vests over casual clothes.
- **Delivery Rider:** Shot in the campus parking lot next to a parked scooter or motorcycle.

- Barangay Shed: Shot at any campus gazebo, outdoor bench, or covered walkway.
- Family Home: Dorm room corner. The baby is a swaddled towel/blanket bundle held close to the actor's chest (camera shot over the shoulder).
- IT Command Center: Dimly lit campus computer lab or desk with laptops displaying code/network graphs.

## CHAPTER 1 - THE BIG BLOWOUT BUZZ

INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

A classroom is alive with conversation before the next lesson. Ten to twelve CLASSMATES sit in small groups, comparing products on their phones and showing one another the items already waiting in their online carts. A bright advertisement fills their screens: ECOCART BIG BLOWOUT SALE - UP TO 70% OFF.

STUDENT 1

Kita namo sa sale sa EcoCart Big  
Blowout?

STUDENT 2

Grabe ba! 50% discount sa tanan

STUDENT 3

Hapit na mag start kay duol na 12

STUDENT 4

Nag add to cart na gani ko oh arun ditso  
na dayun check out

STUDENT 5

Same. Halosa school supplies akong gi  
pang add to cart

The other classmates lift their phones and speak over one another, their excitement filling the room.

CLASSMATES

Sapatos ako! Headset akoo! Ayaw mog  
kalimot sa discount code ha! Dungan tag  
checkout!

The school bell rings. The students settle into their seats, but nearly every phone remains open to the EcoCart countdown page.

STUDENT 1

Guys, pa hotspot bi nahutdan ko ug load.  
Mag sugod na. Pa connect please.

INT. ECOCART STORE - DAY

The EcoCart store is busy with final preparations. Employees organize products, check order lists, and place sale signs around the counter. Customers move through the aisles while the STORE MANAGER watches a screen displaying the rising number of online visitors.

STORE MANAGER

Everyone, today is our biggest online sale. Make sure every order is processed as quickly as possible.

EMPLOYEE 1

Website traffic is already increasing.

EMPLOYEE 2

Thousands of customers are waiting for the sale to begin.

STORE MANAGER

Good. Let's make this our most successful sale yet.

The employees return to their stations. On the monitor, the countdown continues toward twelve noon.

## CHAPTER 2 - THE SALE REACHES THE COMMUNITY

EXT. CONSTRUCTION SITE / ROADSIDE - DAY

Five to six CONSTRUCTION WORKERS rest beside stacked materials during their lunch break. Their helmets and tools lie nearby. A PICK ME RIDER waits at the roadside, checking his phone before accepting another booking.

WORKER 1

Sa sale sa EcoCart ba, unsa inyong  
paliton? Boots ako bay para diri sa  
trabaho

WORKER 2

Ay oo ba naa man diay sale. Sakto guba  
na akong helmet, kana nalang akong  
paliton.

WORKER 3

Apil diba tools? Apili nalanv ko bi,  
bayad rako.

The Pick Me rider turns his phone so the workers can see the items inside his cart.

PICK ME RIDER

Phone holder akoang paliton uy kay lisud  
kaayo mag sigeg tan-aw sa cellphone sa  
direction.

WORKER 4

Ako nimo apilan na na nimog raincoat

PICK ME RIDER

Mana uy, ga hulat nalang kog 12.

A notification appears. The workers immediately reach for their phones.

WORKERS

Nagsugod na ang sale!!

EXT. BARANGAY WAITING SHED - DAY

Six to eight NANAYS AND BARANGAY RESIDENTS sit together beneath a waiting shed. Their conversation is serious at first, with several residents reacting strongly to the latest neighborhood concern.

NANAY 1

Mare, kadungog mo atung chika sulod sa barangay?

NANAY 2

Oo uy, mao manang wala nahuman na drainage. Ambot ana nila.

NANAY 3

Adtu gani mo sa amoa diba inig gabii wagyud moy makita sa dalan kay ang mga suga wa gyud nasugdan ug taud!

NANAY 4

Mao bitaw na nag pa tawag ug meeting utro si Kapitan

Nanay 1 glances at her phone. Her expression changes immediately.

NANAY 1

Hoy! nag sugod na ang sale!!

NANAY 2

Hala taysa, kalha akong paliton run

NANAY 3

Kurtina akoa

NANAY 4

Send link bi, unya nata tiwas ug marites aning issue daris barangay

The residents crowd around the phone. Their discussion shifts completely from barangay concerns to discounts and shopping carts.

INT. SMALL HOUSE - DAY

A MOTHER holds her infant while reviewing a handwritten list of expenses. Baby formula, diapers, medicine, and clothing are written beside carefully calculated prices. Two FAMILY MEMBERS sit beside her.

MOTHER

Baby formula, diapers, clothes, and medicine. Gaka mahal naman tanan palitonon uy.

FAMILY MEMBER 1

Hon, naa ra bay sale karun ang EcoCart. Tanan 50%.

MOTHER



Diay? Maypa.

She opens the EcoCart website and begins adding essential items to her cart.

FAMILY MEMBER 2

Only buy what the baby needs.

MOTHER

Yes, Hon. I'll use the money I save for  
the baby's checkup.

She adds diapers, baby clothes, and feeding bottles, then watches the countdown approach zero.

MOTHER

I'm ready. I just need to check out.

### CHAPTER 3 - THE WEBSITE GOES DOWN

INT. SARAH'S BEDROOM - DAY

SARAH sits in front of her laptop with the EcoCart website open. Several classmates appear through a group video call, while others may be shown in separate split-screen shots. The countdown reaches its final seconds.

WEBSITE COUNTDOWN  
Three... two... one...

SARAH  
The sale is live!

Everyone begins clicking. Product pages open, carts update, and checkout buttons flash across different screens.

CLASSMATE 1  
Nakuha nako ang sapatos! YES!

CLASSMATE 2  
Loading pa akola do.

SARAH  
Check out nako.

Sarah clicks CHECKOUT. The page freezes. The loading icon spins without stopping.

SARAH  
Hala! di lagi?

She refreshes the page. A message fills the screen: SERVER ERROR. PLEASE TRY AGAIN.

CLASSMATE 3  
Ako pud.

CLASSMATE 4  
Down ang website do!

INT. UNKNOWN ROOM - DAY

In a dark room, the ATTACKER sits before several screens. Around the attacker, BOTNET REPRESENTATIVES hold phones, laptops, and signs labeled REQUEST, REFRESH, CONNECT, and LOAD PAGE. Their repeated movements begin slowly, then become faster.

ATTACKER  
Let's see how their server handles this.

The attacker presses a key. The botnet representatives repeatedly raise their devices and signs. On-screen graphics show thousands of connections moving toward one EcoCart server.

NARRATOR (V.O.)

Thousands of fake requests are sent to EcoCart at the same time. The website becomes overwhelmed and can no longer respond to legitimate customers.

## CHAPTER 4 - INCIDENT RESPONSE AND RECOVERY

INT. ECOCART IT OFFICE - DAY

Warning messages appear across the technical team's monitors. One graph rises sharply beyond its normal range. SERVER ADMIN 1 and SERVER ADMIN 2 compare traffic logs while the STORE MANAGER waits behind them.

SERVER ADMIN 1

Website traffic has increased far beyond normal levels.

SERVER ADMIN 2

Oo. Kadaghanan sa requests gikan sa suspicious ug balik-balik nga sources.

STORE MANAGER

Are customer accounts being stolen?

SERVER ADMIN 1

Sa karon, wala pa mi nakita nga naay na-steal nga customer accounts. Murag Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDoS) attack ni.

STORE MANAGER

What does that mean?

SERVER ADMIN 2

Basically sir, gi-flood sa attacker ang website ug fake traffic. Ang server nato sige ug process ana nga fake requests, mao nga dili na ka-access ang atong legitimate customers.

STORE MANAGER

How do we stop it?

SERVER ADMIN 1

Activate rate limiting. Reduce repeated requests and block the most suspicious sources.

SERVER ADMIN 2

I'll contact our security provider. They can redirect the traffic through a scrubbing service before it reaches our server.

The server administrators begin working. New filters appear on the screen as suspicious connections are separated from legitimate customer traffic.

SERVER ADMIN 1

Rate limiting is active.

SERVER ADMIN 2

Malicious traffic is being filtered and blocked.

STORE MANAGER

Keep monitoring the system. We need to restore the website safely.

CUSTOMER IMPACT MONTAGE - VARIOUS LOCATIONS

Quick cuts return to the groups waiting across the community. Each customer sees the same loading screen or server error.

STUDENT 2

Wala na 'di na ko ka order.

WORKER 1

Naa pa sa cart akong boots.

PICK ME RIDER

Lakaw na lang sa ko kay naay booking.

NANAY 2

Na unsa mani?.

NANAY 3

Akong kalha ani impas gyud.

MOTHER

I hope the baby products do not sell out.

NARRATOR (V.O.)

The attack prevents customers from completing their purchases. EcoCart loses sales, while legitimate users experience delays and frustration. A DDoS attack mainly targets availability, but the company must still investigate carefully to confirm that no other systems were affected.

INT. SARAH'S BEDROOM - LATER

Sarah opens her laptop again and presses refresh. This time, the EcoCart homepage appears normally. Product images load, the cart remains intact, and the checkout button responds.

SARAH

Yes naa na!

She reviews her order and clicks CHECKOUT. A confirmation page appears: THANK YOU FOR YOUR PURCHASE!

SARAH

Finally!

Her classmates celebrate as their orders also go through. A final notification appears on their screens: ECO CART SERVICES HAVE BEEN RESTORED. THANK YOU FOR YOUR PATIENCE.

## CHAPTER 5 - THE ECOCART INCIDENT MEETING

INT. ECOCART CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY

The following morning, the SELLER, STORE MANAGER, SERVER ADMINISTRATORS, CYBERSECURITY ANALYST, and INCIDENT RESPONSE LEAD sit around a conference table. A screen behind them displays: ECOCART DDoS INCIDENT REPORT.

SELLER

Yesterday was supposed to be our biggest sale. Instead, our website suddenly became unavailable. What exactly happened?

SERVER ADMIN 1

Our server received an unusually large number of requests within a very short period.

The screen displays a graph showing normal traffic followed by a sudden and extreme spike.

SELLER

Was all of that traffic caused by real customers joining the sale?

SERVER ADMIN 2

Naay uban nga requests gikan sa tinuod nga customers, pero kadaghanan gikan sa libo-libong compromised devices nga gi-control sa attacker.  
attacker.

CYBERSECURITY ANALYST

This was a Distributed Denial-of-Service, or DDoS, attack. The attacker used a botnet to repeatedly send fake requests to the EcoCart website.

A simple diagram appears: many infected devices point toward one overloaded EcoCart server, while legitimate customers remain outside the connection.

STORE MANAGER

So the large amount of fake traffic caused the website to stop responding?

SERVER ADMIN 1

Yes sir. Na-consume sa fake traffic ang available resources sa server, mao nga dili na siya maka-respond ug tarong sa legitimate users.

SELLER

What did the team do after the attack was detected?

INCIDENT RESPONSE LEAD

First, we confirmed the abnormal traffic and recorded the affected systems. We activated rate limiting, blocked repeated suspicious requests, and protected the checkout service from further overload.

SERVER ADMIN 2

Gi-redirect pud namo ang incoming traffic ngadto sa atong security provider. Ang ilang scrubbing service mao ang nag-separate sa malicious requests ug legitimate customer traffic before ipadala balik ang clean traffic sa atong server.

SELLER

Was any customer information stolen?

CYBERSECURITY ANALYST

Based on our investigation, wala mi nakita nga evidence nga na-access ang customer accounts o payment information. Ang biggest impact kay na-disrupt lang ang service. Padayon gihapon mi ug review sa logs para masiguro nga wala'y lain related activity nga na-miss.

STORE MANAGER

What will we do to prevent this from happening during the next sale?

CYBERSECURITY ANALYST

We will strengthen DDoS protection, improve real-time traffic monitoring, configure automatic rate limiting, and use filtering rules that block suspicious requests before they reach the main server.



SERVER ADMIN 1

We will place critical services behind a content delivery network and prepare safe failover systems. We will also test our capacity before every major sale.

INCIDENT RESPONSE LEAD

The company will maintain an updated incident response plan. Each team member will know who detects the threat, who communicates with customers, who contacts the provider, and who approves system recovery.

SELLER

Then our priorities are clear: prepare before the event, detect unusual traffic early, respond quickly, restore services safely, and improve our defenses after every incident.

Everyone around the table nods. The screen changes from the incident graph to a short mitigation plan.

STORE MANAGER

We need to protect both the business and our customers, especially during high-traffic events.

SELLER

Agreed. Apply these improvements before our next online sale.

The screen displays: MONITOR UNUSUAL TRAFFIC. APPLY RATE LIMITING. FILTER MALICIOUS REQUESTS. USE A DDoS PROTECTION PROVIDER. PREPARE FAILOVER SYSTEMS. MAINTAIN AN INCIDENT RESPONSE PLAN.

NARRATOR (V.O.)

Effective threat mitigation requires preparation, early detection, coordinated response, safe recovery, and continuous improvement.

The EcoCart logo appears with the message: STAY SECURE. KEEP THE TRAFFIC FLOWING.

The image fades to black. Closing credits begin, allowing the remaining ensemble members to be recognized.

— THE END —